

A sample clause could read, “In case of termination of project, an invoice for work done till then will be raised which will be payable immediately. The charges are to be calculated as 20% of final bill expected bill amount if project is cancelled before XXX date and 50% if cancelled after XXX date.”

Point of contact

If you start fielding calls from multiple people of the same organisation, you will soon be going down a dark, dark rabbit hole. You may get several contradictory requests for changes or shifting deadlines and piecemeal information which will waste your time. Maintaining a single point of contact or SPOC, will keep you away from the client’s internal difficulties and discussions. You are interested in the final data given to you, not the methodology and revisions done to it.



Copyright ownership and portfolio use

So why are you doing this project? For the money of course.

And because it aligns with your area of expertise and you want to showcase it as a portfolio piece. So you finish the work, get paid and happily upload it on your website or the portfolio hosting site that you use. Two days later you get a mail from the client saying that you have to remove it from public forum and cannot display it anywhere. Whaaaaaaaat....

Do not gloss over or skim this topic, it is vital to keep you legally clear and use it in your portfolio

Enter this lifesaver. Always mention in your contract that the work done by you will be posted on public websites with the appropriate ownership attributes specified. In case the work done contains any confidential data or business secrets, you can specify that only a screenshot will be posted with a description of the work without revealing the details.

Copyright is always a minefield and usually you need a lawyer to tackle the finer points. Before you search copyright lawyers in Google, let’s understand the issues that need to be addressed when it comes to intellectual property. Say for example you have designed an infographic for a client. You need to discuss with your client who owns the copyright at the end of the project. If you own it, you need to assign usage permissions to the client. In case you don’t own it or can’t, as is the case for logo designing, issue of